CSIS CHINA PROGRAMS

China Daily Brief

Sunday, November 8, 2026

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RE: Xi-Trump-Putin summit talks confirmed · Hegseth-Paparo China visit floated · PBOC hikes FX reserve ratio · Nvidia's Huang probed over alleged spy tie

USD/CNY	SSE COMPOSITE	HANG SENG	BRENT
6.6710	3,649.18	24,481.86	$98.32
▲ +0.15%	▲ +0.31%	▲ +5.10%	▼ -5.10%

IN THIS ISSUE Top Stories · US-China · The World · Beijing · Markets · Statements · Analysis · Overnight · The Wire · Upcoming

TODAY AT A GLANCE

1. Beijing confirmed for the first time it is discussing a Xi-Trump-Putin trilateral meeting, likely this month on the sidelines of the Shenzhen APEC summit, MOFA spokeswoman Mao Ning said.
2. US Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and INDOPACOM commander Adm. Samuel Paparo may visit China soon, which would be the first PACOM commander trip to Beijing since 2015, according to the National Committee on US-China Relations president.
3. The PBOC raised banks' foreign-currency reserve requirement ratio from 4% to 6%, effective Nov. 15, the first such hike since December 2021, after the yuan broke through 6.65 per dollar on Nov. 2.

TOP STORIES

DIPLOMACY

Beijing confirms talks underway on a Xi-Trump-Putin trilateral meeting

MOFA spokeswoman **Mao Ning** said China 'is in communication with relevant parties regarding a meeting between the three heads of state,' the first Chinese confirmation of discussions for a historic three-way summit. The gathering, if it happens, would take place this month on the sidelines of the APEC summit China is hosting in Shenzhen. USTR **Jamieson Greer** separately pressed Vice Premier **He Lifeng** in a Friday call to take 'concrete actions' on past commitments, a sign of persistent friction even as the truce holds.

TAIPEI TIMES

US-CHINA

Hegseth and INDOPACOM's Paparo may visit China soon, says US-China relations group head

The president of the National Committee on US-China Relations said at a Sanya maritime forum that Defense Secretary **Pete Hegseth** and Adm. **Samuel Paparo** may visit China 'very soon,' which would be the first PACOM commander trip to Beijing since 2015. The two militaries held a crisis-communication working group in Washington Nov. 2-3, and Paparo met PLA Eastern Theater Commander Yang Zhibin in Canada in August, restoring a theater-level channel dormant for two years. The Pentagon and INDOPACOM said they have nothing to announce, and Hegseth faces domestic pressure over his position following Republican midterm losses.

LIANHE ZAOBAO

PLA

AEI-ISW report flags possible large unannounced PLA Taiwan-isolation exercise

The American Enterprise Institute and the Institute for the Study of War said China may be conducting an unannounced exercise simulating Taiwan's isolation, larger than last year's 'Justice Mission 2025,' drawing forces from the eastern, northern and southern theater commands. NSC Secretary-General **Joseph Wu** said *more than 100* PLA Navy and Coast Guard vessels are operating in the western Pacific, with the Liaoning carrier group having transited the Basilan Strait between Oct. 23 and the prior Monday.

TAIPEI TIMES

TECHNOLOGY

US intelligence believes Nvidia's Huang had romantic tie to alleged Chinese spy

US intelligence officials warned Nvidia CEO **Jensen Huang** that he was involved with an executive recruited by China to gather information on the company, according to the FT. The report emerged as Huang's daughter, Nvidia physical-AI marketing executive Madison Huang, abruptly cancelled a Seoul trip citing 'family reasons.'

FINANCIAL TIMES

PRC-ECONOMY

PBOC raises FX reserve ratio to 6% for first time since 2021, cooling yuan rally

The central bank will raise banks' foreign-currency deposit reserve requirement ratio from 4% to *6%* effective Nov. 15, freezing an estimated $24 billion in FX liquidity. The move follows a yuan rally that broke through 6.65 per dollar on Nov. 2 after 14 straight trading-day gains and a 4.2% appreciation over the first nine months of 2026.

ECONOMIC DAILY

OVERNIGHT

TECHNOLOGY

China to fly first Pakistani astronaut to Tiangong on Shenzhou-24 · UDN (联合报)

China's manned space agency said a Pakistani astronaut will join the Shenzhou-24 crew as a payload specialist, marking Tiangong's first foreign visitor. The two countries signed a selection-and-training agreement in Islamabad in February 2025; two Pakistani candidates completed training in China.

TECHNOLOGY

Nvidia CEO's daughter cancels Seoul trip after father's spy-link report · Liberty Times (自由时报)

Madison Huang, Nvidia's head of physical-AI marketing, scrapped a planned meeting with South Korea's deputy PM and a keynote at Nvidia AI Day Seoul, citing 'family reasons.' The cancellation follows a report that US intelligence believes her father Jensen Huang had a romantic relationship with an executive recruited by China.

DIPLOMACY

King Charles III reportedly weighing a China visit · Hong Kong Economic Journal (信报)

AFP cited a Buckingham Palace aide saying the king is carefully weighing a visit to China, which his aides described as a country of 'great importance and great complexity.' Charles last visited in 1997 for the Hong Kong handover; his mother was the only British monarch to visit the mainland, in 1986.

DEFENSE

Japan's defense minister floats restructuring JSDF service branches · CCTV News

Defense Minister Shinjiro Koizumi said Japan should explore breaking down organizational barriers between the Ground, Maritime and Air Self-Defense Forces as part of the year-end revision of Japan's security strategy documents. He cited shrinking population as a constraint on maintaining troop numbers.

PLA

China's first female carrier-based aviation pilot cadets graduate · MND (国防部)

The PLA Navy's first cohort of women trained as carrier-based fighter pilots completed their course and were assigned to frontline units, per a Defense Ministry release. No further operational details were given.

DIPLOMACY

He Lifeng to chair second China-Canada economic and financial dialogue · Morning Post (早晨报)

Vice Premier He Lifeng will travel to Canada to co-chair the second round of the bilateral Economic and Financial Strategic Dialogue, per Chinese reporting. No agenda details were disclosed.

DIPLOMACY

FM says Japan bears 'full responsibility' for strained ties, a year after Takaichi's Taiwan remarks · Global Times

China's foreign ministry marked the one-year anniversary of Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's remarks on Taiwan by again placing blame for the diplomatic rupture squarely on Tokyo. The headline did not carry further detail on any new measures.

CROSS-STRAIT

Taiwan's MOFA condemns China over Gabon joint statement citing UN 2758 · Taipei Times

Taipei accused Beijing of pressuring Gabon into a joint statement distorting UN Resolution 2758, which it noted never mentions Taiwan, after Xi Jinping's Nov. 6 meeting with Gabonese President Brice Clotaire Oligui Nguema. MOFA said the ROC 'has never been ruled by the People's Republic of China.'

US–CHINA

TARIFF · CHINA TIMES (中国时报)

Bessent, Greer warn He Lifeng to honor Busan truce ahead of APEC, G20

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and USTR Jamieson Greer held a call Nov. 6 with Vice Premier He Lifeng warning Beijing must implement last year's Busan truce commitments, per FT reporting cited by China Times. Xi and Trump are expected to meet again at the Shenzhen APEC summit and the Doral G20.

SANCTIONS · MOFA PRESSER (外交部发言人)

MOFA protests new US Cuba sanctions naming two Chinese companies

China's foreign ministry said it 'firmly supports' Cuba's sovereignty and will take 'all necessary measures' to protect the legitimate rights of the two Chinese firms added to the latest US sanctions list on Cuba. No further designation details were given in the release.

TARIFF · UDN (联合报)

US agri-food exporters cite tariff, market-access friction at CIIE

US meat and soybean trade representatives at Shanghai's import expo said Chinese customs inspection standards and tariffs remain the main hurdles to the China market, even as buyers return. An Indiana soybean grower said farmers welcome renewed Chinese purchases but 'shouldn't focus too much on any single market.'

LEGAL · NIKKEI ASIA

Joshua Wong's 10-year sentence triggers US-Europe rebuke of Beijing

The prison sentence handed to Hong Kong democracy activist Joshua Wong Chi-fung has drawn condemnation from Washington and European capitals. The dispute adds to friction over Hong Kong's national security law enforcement.

CHINA & THE WORLD

CROSS-STRAIT · AP

Taiwan detains Communist Party leader over alleged Chinese election sponsorship

Taiwan prosecutors detained a local Chinese Communist Party-affiliated leader on suspicion of receiving Chinese sponsorship tied to an upcoming election. The case adds to an already large vote-buying probe ahead of the Nov. 28 local elections.

CROSS-STRAIT · TAIPEI TIMES

IPAC names Taiwan Strait peace, anti-coercion resilience as top 2027 priorities

The Inter-Parliamentary Alliance on China's summit in The Hague, with 52 lawmakers from 30 countries, voted Taiwan Strait peace and resilience against Chinese economic coercion as its priorities for the coming year. Dutch co-chair Jan Paternotte cited Taiwan's role in semiconductors and strait shipping volumes as grounds for global concern.

AFRICA · MOFA (外交部)

Xi and Gabon's president upgrade ties to 'community of destiny,' sign zero-tariff deals

Xi Jinping and Gabonese President Brice Clotaire Oligui Nguema announced a 'new-era China-Gabon community of common destiny' during a Nov. 6 state visit, signing documents on the Global Security Initiative, zero-tariff treatment and Chinese-language education. Gabon reaffirmed the one-China principle and endorsed Xi's four global initiatives.

KOREA · MOFA (外交部)

Politburo Standing Committee's Cai Qi meets North Korean party delegation

Cai Qi told a visiting Workers' Party of Korea delegation led by international department head Kim Song-nam that the two sides should implement the consensus from Xi's June visit to Pyongyang. The meeting followed Kim Jong Un's recent surprise same-day China trip via a new Yalu River bridge.

INDIA · DW CHINESE

India reports fresh China border face-offs in Arunachal Pradesh

India's border police chief Shatrujeet Kapur said Chinese and Indian forces faced off at multiple points along the disputed line in Arunachal Pradesh, which Beijing calls South Tibet. MOFA spokesperson Guo Jiakun said China conducts 'normal patrol and management activities' in the area and abides by prior bilateral agreements.

JAPAN · REUTERS

Astellas employee jailed in China on spying charge set for December release

A Japanese Astellas Pharma executive imprisoned in China on espionage charges is expected to be released in mid-December after completing his sentence, Japanese media reported. He is among several Japanese nationals detained in China under its anti-espionage law since 2015.

ASEAN · CNA

Manila rebukes own officials over China remarks ahead of regional summit

The Philippines' Department of Foreign Affairs issued a rare warning to government agencies to speak with 'a unified voice' on China, after senators called for Beijing's ambassador to be declared persona non grata over 'easily win' remarks. Beijing had accused Manila of 'erecting multiple obstacles' to its attendance at an ASEAN defense ministers' meeting.

RUSSIA-CENTRAL ASIA · MOFA (外交部)

Han Zheng visits Georgia, pledges continued support on Taiwan and Xinjiang issues

> Vice President Han Zheng met Georgian President Mikheil Kavelashvili and PM Irakli Kobakhidze in Tbilisi, thanking Georgia for backing China's position on Taiwan and Xinjiang and pledging reciprocal support for Georgian sovereignty. The visit follows the June 2026 upgrade of ties to a comprehensive strategic partnership.

STAT OF THE DAY

$24B

FX liquidity frozen by PBOC's reserve-ratio hike

The two-point increase in the foreign-currency deposit reserve ratio, from 4% to 6% effective Nov. 15, is calculated against roughly $1.2 trillion in foreign-currency deposits as of September and is the first such move since Dec. 15, 2021.

Economic Daily (中国经济网)

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

MACRO · BLOOMBERG

AI slump revives Asia's 'forgotten trades' from China to India

Investors are rotating back into pre-AI-boom Asian sectors as the AI trade cools, Bloomberg reports.

ENERGY · BLOOMBERG

China set to lead world in energy investment in 2026, state broadcaster says

CCTV reported China will top global energy-investment rankings this year, per Bloomberg's pickup of the state broadcast.

TECH / SOFTBANK, ABB · NIKKEI ASIA

China blocks SoftBank's $5.4 billion purchase of ABB's robotics unit

Chinese regulators moved to halt SoftBank's planned acquisition of Swiss-Swedish group ABB's robotics division. ABB's robotics business, with global headquarters in Shanghai, was notably absent from ABB's CIIE booth this week.

MANUFACTURING / HUAXIN BUILDING MATERIALS, CSN CIMENTOS · 21ST CENTURY BUSINESS HERALD

Huaxin Building Materials to buy Brazil's CSN Cimentos for $1.64 billion

Huaxin will pay roughly 9.03 billion reais ($1.64 billion) for 99.99% of CSN Cimentos, Brazil's No. 2 cement maker with *17 million tons/year* of capacity, marking the first entry by a Chinese cement firm into Brazil.

MANUFACTURING · CCTV NEWS

China's second domestically built large cruise ship docks alongside the first

The newly delivered 'Adora Flower City' met sister ship 'Adora Magic City' at Shanghai's Wusongkou port, marking China's shift from a single prototype to series production of large cruise liners.

ENERGY / CNNC · PEOPLE'S DAILY WORLD

Fuqing nuclear plant showcases 'Hualong One' reactor exports

China's state nuclear operator said *47* Hualong One units are now approved or under construction worldwide, with each unit generating enough power for a mid-sized developed country's population of one million.

WHAT BEIJING DID

STATE COUNCIL + MINISTRIES · SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 8, 2026

国务院 · STATE COUNCIL · *Li Qiang, Premier*

Executive meeting orders stock-market stabilization, local debt risk resolution

The Nov. 6 State Council executive meeting called for improving the capital-market stabilization mechanism and enhancing the stock market's 'inherent stability,' alongside continued resolution of local government debt and small/mid financial institution risk.

→ MOFCOM ↗

PERSONNEL CHANGES

First cohort of women aviators (unnamed) GRADUATED
Carrier-based aviation pilots
The PLA Navy's first group of female carrier-based fighter pilot cadets completed training and were assigned to frontline units, per a Defense Ministry release.

NPC / POLITBURO WATCH

CCP CENTRAL COMMITTEE
Raises delegate count to 2,360 for 2027 Party Congress
Bloomberg reported Beijing has increased the number of delegates to the 21st Party Congress, due in 2027, to 2,360; the Central Organization Department separately confirmed delegate-election procedures are underway.

WHAT BEIJING IS SAYING

外交部 · MOFA · XI-TRUMP-PUTIN TRILATERAL MEETING DISCUSSIONS — ROUTINE · TO OTHER

Mao Ning '· MOFA spokesperson

“China is in communication with relevant parties regarding a meeting between the three heads of state.”

Asked about reports of a possible three-way summit timed to the Shenzhen APEC meeting this month.

Taipei Times

外交部 · MOFA · US SANCTIONS ON CUBA NAMING CHINESE FIRMS — FIRM · TO US

MOFA spokesperson '· MOFA spokesperson

“China firmly supports Cuba in safeguarding its national sovereignty, and will take all necessary measures to firmly safeguard the legitimate rights and interests of its own enterprises.”

中方坚定支持古巴维护国家主权，将采取一切必要措施坚定维护本国企业的正当权益

Responding to a new round of US sanctions on Cuba that named two Chinese companies.

极目新闻 via MOFA presser

外交部 · MOFA · US-CHINA TRADE RELATIONS — CONCILIATORY · TO US

MOFA spokesperson '· MOFA spokesperson

“China and the US must move toward each other to promote the sustained, steady and sound development of economic and trade relations.”

中美要相向而行推动经贸关系持续稳定向好发展

Statement issued as Treasury and USTR officials pressed He Lifeng on Busan-deal implementation ahead of the Shenzhen APEC summit.

China Daily

国务院 · STATE COUNCIL · ECONOMIC POLICY, STOCK-MARKET STABILIZATION — ROUTINE · TO DOMESTIC

Li Qiang '· Premier

“Improve the capital market stabilization mechanism, enhance the stock market's inherent stability, and promote stable and healthy development of the capital market.”

完善资本市场稳市机制，增强股市内在稳定性，促进资本市场平稳健康发展

From the readout of the Nov. 6 State Council executive meeting on fourth-quarter economic priorities.

MOFCOM

习近平 · XI JINPING · CHINA-GABON RELATIONS — CONCILIATORY · TO OTHER

Xi Jinping '· President

“China is willing to be a reliable friend and partner in Gabon's independent and autonomous development.”

中方愿做加方独立自主发展的可靠朋友和伙伴

Remarks during the Nov. 6 state visit of Gabonese President Brice Clotaire Oligui Nguema, during which the two sides elevated ties to a 'community of common destiny.'

MOFA

WHAT OTHERS ARE SAYING

TAIPEI TIMES · NOV 8, 2026

Sun Yun · Director, China Program, Stimson Center

“I think it will happen. The question is the format and the content.”

Comment on prospects for a Xi-Trump-Putin trilateral meeting Beijing has confirmed discussing for this month's Shenzhen APEC summit.

source

LIANHE ZAOBAO · NOV 6-8, 2026

Stephen Orlins (欧伦斯) · President, National Committee on US-China Relations

“As far as I understand, Secretary Hegseth and Admiral Paparo may visit China very soon.”

Said via video address to the Global Ocean Cooperation and Governance Forum in Sanya; a Paparo visit would be INDOPACOM's first to China since 2015.

source

DW CHINESE · OCT 2026 REMARKS

Shatrujeet Kapur · Director-General, India border police force

“Dealing with China through conventional means could be difficult, because their PLA and border forces are far ahead in military investment and modernization.”

Comment followed renewed reports of China-India troop face-offs in Arunachal Pradesh along the unresolved Line of Actual Control.

source

THE WIRE

DIPLOMACY

SCMP

Canada plans to clear 30,000-case Hongkonger migration backlog by 2027

Ottawa added quota spaces to its Hong Kong immigration pathway; advocates call the goal achievable but uncertain.

PEOPLE'S DAILY WORLD

China-Pacific development dialogue held alongside CIIE

Samoa's and Solomon Islands' envoys pressed for tariff-free access for Pacific island exports to China.

MARITIME

PEOPLE'S DAILY WORLD

Seventh Ocean Cooperation and Governance Forum opens in Sanya

400-plus officials and experts from 30-plus countries discussed South China Sea maritime safety rules and Arctic governance.

ECONOMY

GUANCHA (观察者网)

Nestlé, Danone, Coca-Cola bottler detail fresh China investment at CIIE

Nestlé cited nearly 1 billion yuan in new 2026 China investment; Swire Coca-Cola reaffirmed its 12-billion-yuan, ten-year China plan.

UPCOMING

Nov 9

NBS releases October CPI, PPI data

China's National Bureau of Statistics publishes October consumer and producer price indices Monday.

Nov 10

Busan-deal suspensions approach lapse

The one-year suspensions of BIS's Affiliates ("50%") Rule and China's October 2025 rare-earth export controls, both dated from Nov. 10, 2025, approach expiry unless extended.

Nov 18

APEC Economic Leaders' Meeting, Shenzhen

China hosts APEC; multiple outlets report a possible Xi-Trump-Putin trilateral on the sidelines, alongside a bilateral Xi-Trump meeting to maintain the Busan trade truce.

Nov 28

Taiwan nine-in-one local elections

22 mayors and magistrates and roughly 11,000 offices are contested, read as a mid-term referendum on President Lai Ching-te.

Dec 14

G20 Leaders' Summit, Doral (Miami)

The US hosts G20; China Times reports Xi and Trump are expected to meet again here following the Shenzhen APEC encounter.

CSIS China Programs

CHINA DAILY BRIEF

Washington, D.C.

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